

Forlorn Philosopher

The road an unreasoning maze, every temple soaked in blood, each destination drenched in gloom; you once thought that cold analysis might tame Fate itself, now that dream of reason has decayed to shifting madness and only the cold remains.

Begins with **d6x10s** and **d4 Omens**.

HP: Toughness + d4

The Roots of your Dejection? (d8)

- 1 Your mother alternated praise and humiliation leading to grandiose self-image and burning self-hatred.
- 2 You wanted to be a warrior or great leader but you can't! Stop! THINKING! STOP THE THOUGHTS!!
- 3 Ambient stupidity and bright lights cause your hypersensitive mental tissues to INFLAME.
- 4 You could save this doomed world! If only the unwashed masses would understand your GENIUS!
- 5 You fell victim to the mental virus of "love," then the object of your affection went to live in a hole.
- 6 You encoded your omnivalent philosophy in a single tome for safekeeping and saw it burn as you fled. All is lost.
- 7 Udok cultists captured your family and forced you to debate with them while they devoured your parents alive.
- 8 You were Südglans' most revered philosopher—which sank into the sea and now everyone ruthlessly mocks you.

Abilities

Mental Focus, roll 3d6+2 Presence. Too Much Reading! Roll 3d6-2 Strength. Ruthless Inquisition: test Presence DR 14 to tear through others' deceptions and delusions. Enough of these LIES! Roll d6 on the weapon table and d2 on the armor table. You begin with one **Tablet of Ochre Obscurity** and one of the following:

1. THORNS OF COMPREHENSION

When worn, thorns pierce your flesh (d2 damage) and you *Perceive All* (-4DR to your next test and ignore the next two attacks to hit you as you weave aside). To **regain the effect** you must crown yourself anew. The damage steps up by one each time (d2 to d4 to d6 etc), until after a night's rest.

2. HEGELIAN OWL

This philosophical beast is a bitter, reluctant and hypersensitive assistant. —**persuaded** with a DR12 Presence test. After two acts of aid it regards you with mute contempt. It can **fetch small items**, **attack enemies** and **find traps**. By night the owl delivers understanding of what you *should* have done today in dreams.



HEGELIAN OWL

Too quick to hit.
Claws/bite d4. Attacks are DR8.

3. PRISM OF AMBIGUITY

An external light source and a Presence DR10 test are needed to activate the prism. Its light may shine on up to two creatures healing d6 HP. For the next hour one of them lowers all test DRs by -2. If the test is failed they suffer d4 damage and their armor or a weapon is destroyed. You can use the prism twice per day.

4. FLUTE OF TOSK

Once per combat, when a creature dies, you may play this bone flute's Echoing Fugue. This deals an 'echo' of the fatal damage to a random enemy in the vicinity.

5. SASH OF THE STYLITE

The MIND controls the body! Nothing is good or bad but thinking makes it so including calories and protein. Wearing this belt means you feel no hunger and only need to drink water to regain HP when resting. Wearing it for more than d4 days causes you to collapse. It takes a day to regain its power.

6. MARKED BY OBSCURITY

An ever-shifting Tablet of Ochre Obscurity is tattooed on your flesh. Roll each morning which tablet it is. The tablet can only be used once per day but automatically succeeds.

The dejection of your Roots (d6)

1. Raised by fanatical Theists in a temple beneath Grift's bridges.
2. Born to a nameless mother in a Galgenbeck sanatorium.
3. Brought up by illiterate, pig-ignorant churls in a peaceful Wästland forest.
4. Raised by life-shaming cultists of the frozen Kergüs waste who think no one should be born into this dying world.
5. Abandoned in Bergen Chrypt's catacombs.
6. Educated by the damned amongst the Valley of the Unfortunate Undead's mud pits.

